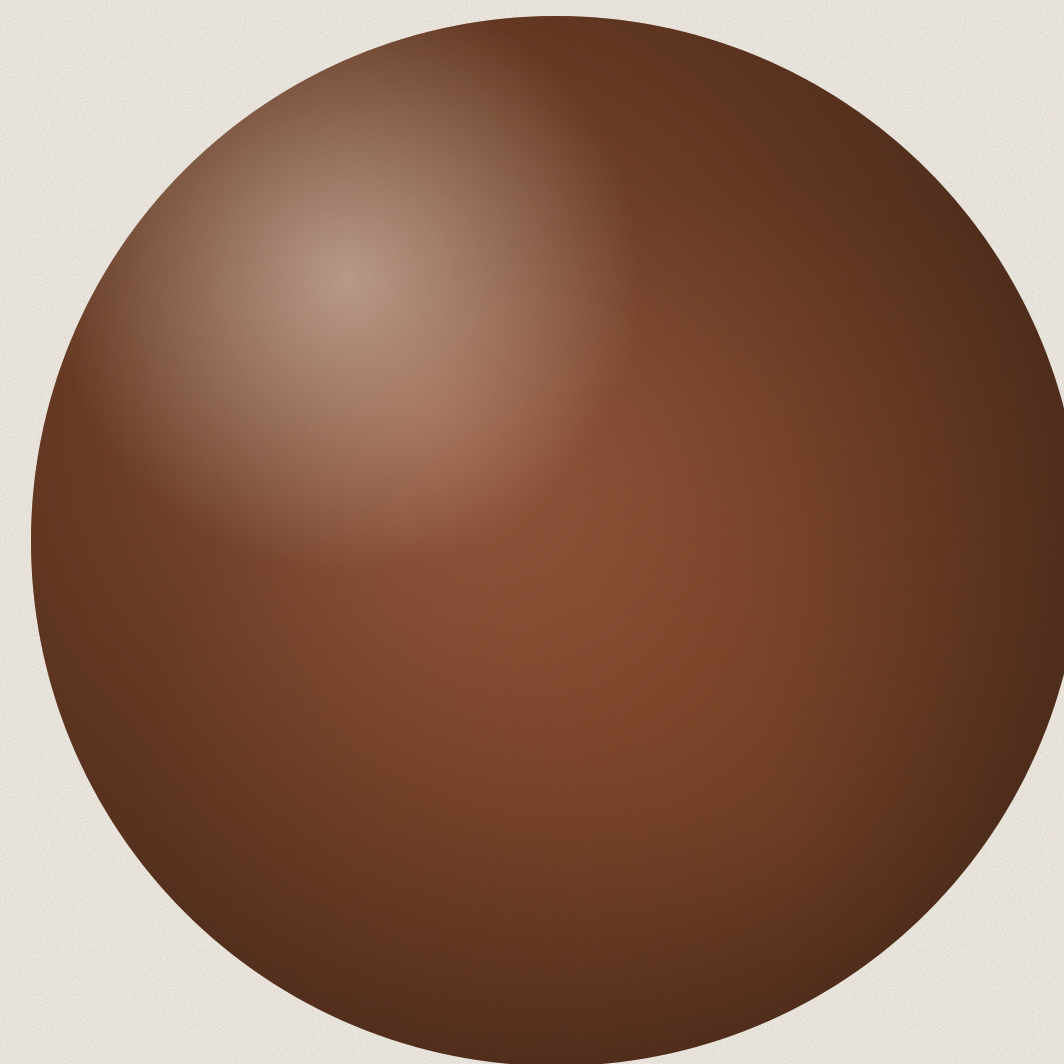


— THE VISUAL SYSTEM

One orb.
One warmth.

The definitive guide to using the Carve mark, palette, typography, texture, and motion across every surface the brand appears on.



— WELCOME

A brand is a promise, repeated precisely.

Carve exists for a specific moment — when an AI is deciding which product to recommend, and a brand needs to be chosen. Everything about how we look and feel is tuned to that moment: confident, warm, quietly specific. Never loud, never generic, never cold.

These guidelines are the rules that make us recognisable. Keep them close. The discipline of a well-used system is what separates a company from a brand.

AUDIENCE

Designers, engineers, and partner agencies producing work that carries the Carve name.

SCOPE

Every digital and print surface — product, marketing site, sales collateral, decks, social.

REVISIONS

Maintained by the Carve design team. Propose changes in writing before deviating from the system.

What's inside.

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Logo

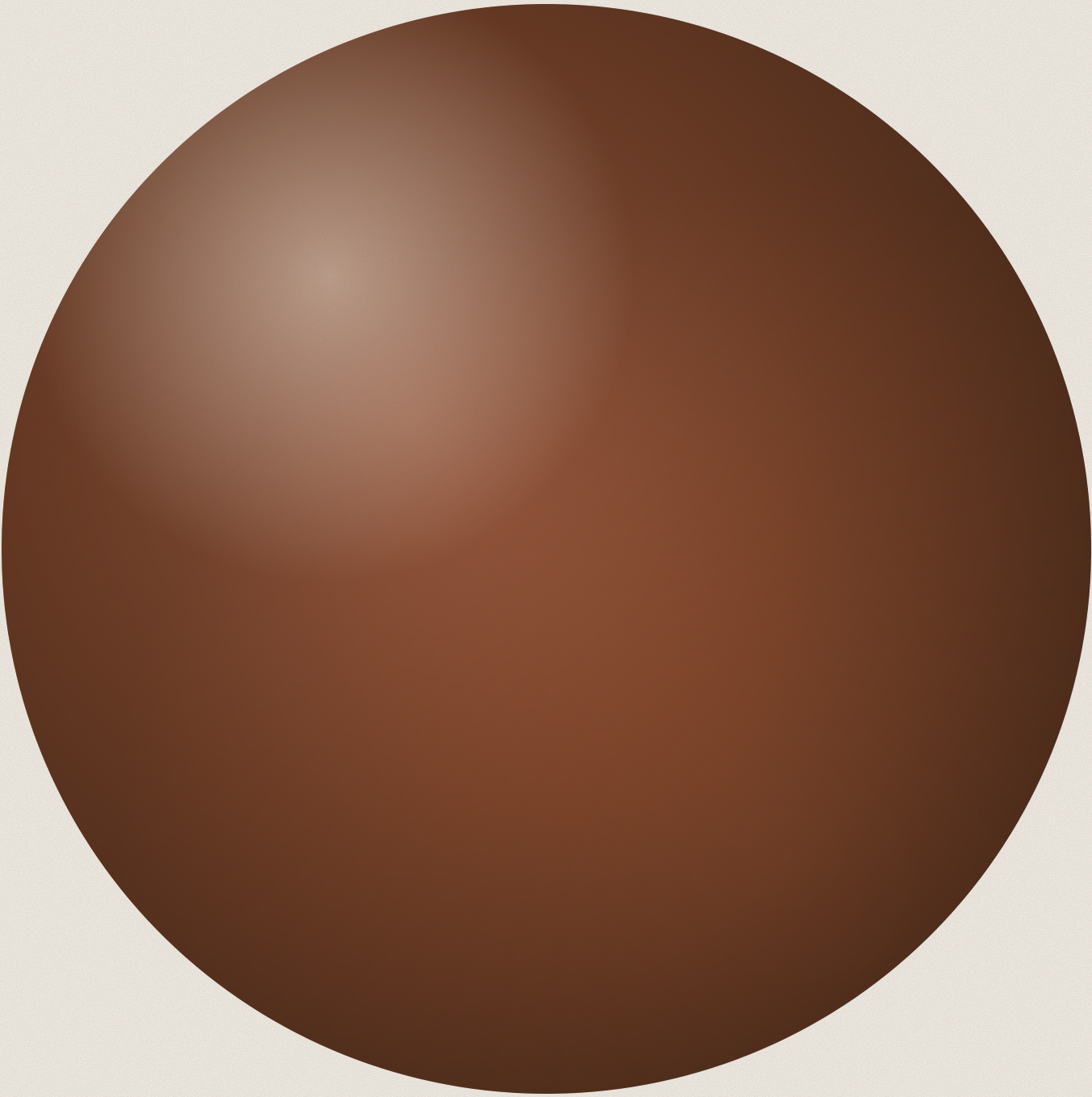
A single polished sphere — the shape of warmth, the shape of commerce found.

— 1.1 · THE ORB

One mark. One finish.

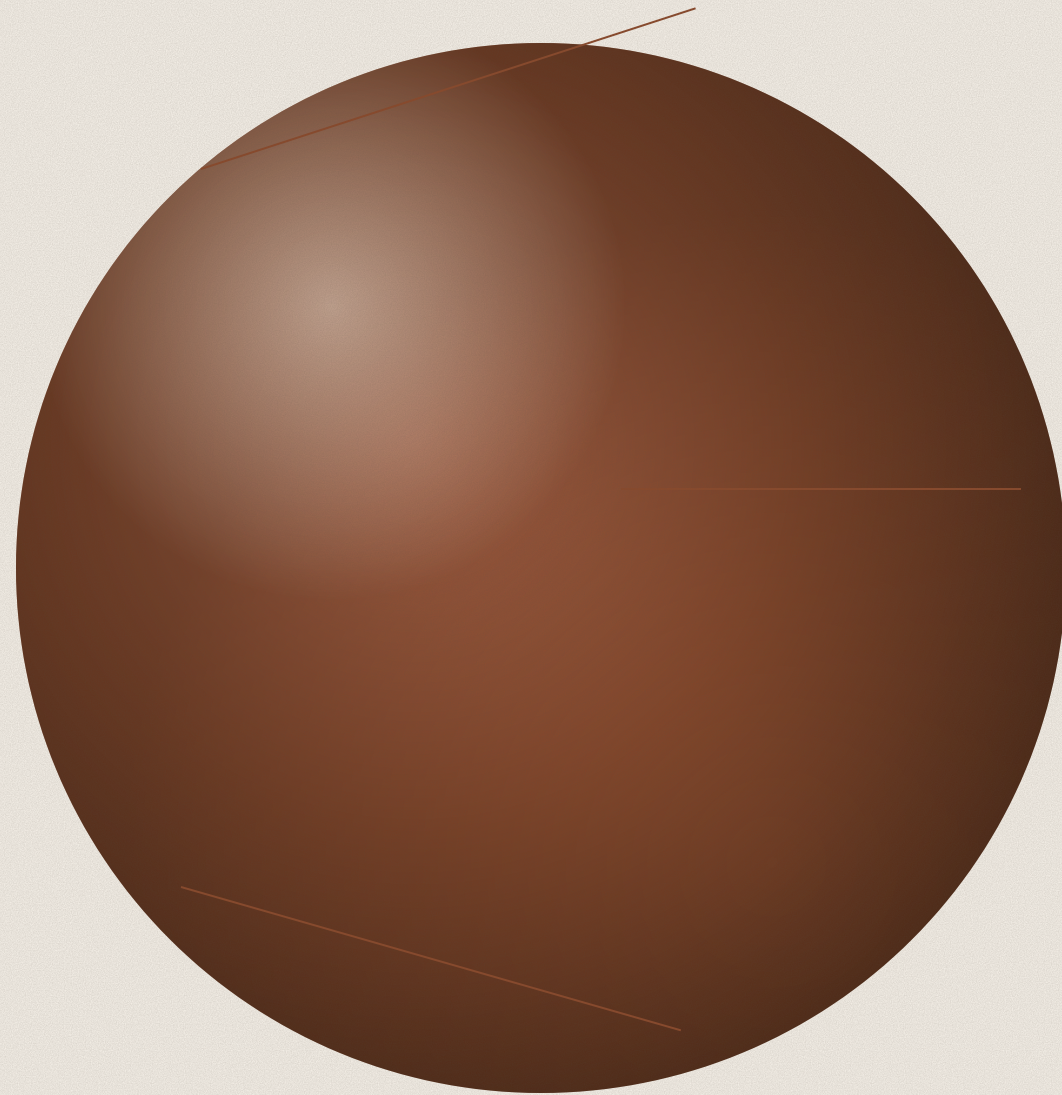
The Carve symbol is a polished terracotta sphere. It has exactly one approved form. No flat variants, no monochrome fallbacks, no simplified silhouettes — the gradient, shadow, and specular highlight are inseparable from the brand.

Reproduce it from the master SVG. Do not rebuild it.



Three layers of light.

The orb is a stack of three radial gradients on a 128-unit canvas. Each layer does one thing. Together they make the surface look lit, not drawn.



01 · BODY GRADIENT

Radial, 38% 38%, 72% reach.

Terracotta soft #C57150 → core #8B4A2C → deep #4A2816. Supplies the mass and the natural shading.

02 · CONTACT SHADOW

Radial, 72% 78%, 62% reach.

Transparent → #1A100A at 32% opacity. Plants the sphere on its ground.

03 · SPECULAR HIGHLIGHT

Radial, 30% 25%, 28% reach.

Warm cream #FFF5E6 at 52% opacity → transparent. The glint of polish. Never darken, never move.

Cormorant, set upright.

The Carve wordmark is the word Carve, set in Cormorant Garamond Semibold, tracked +0.02em, uppercase. It may appear alone or locked up with the orb.

CARVE

TYPEFACE

Cormorant Garamond

WEIGHT

Semibold · 600

CASE

Uppercase

TRACKING

+0.02em

Orb and wordmark, paired.

The horizontal lockup is the default identity mark. Orb height matches cap height of the wordmark. Gap between them is equal to the stem width of the C.



XL · Cover · hero



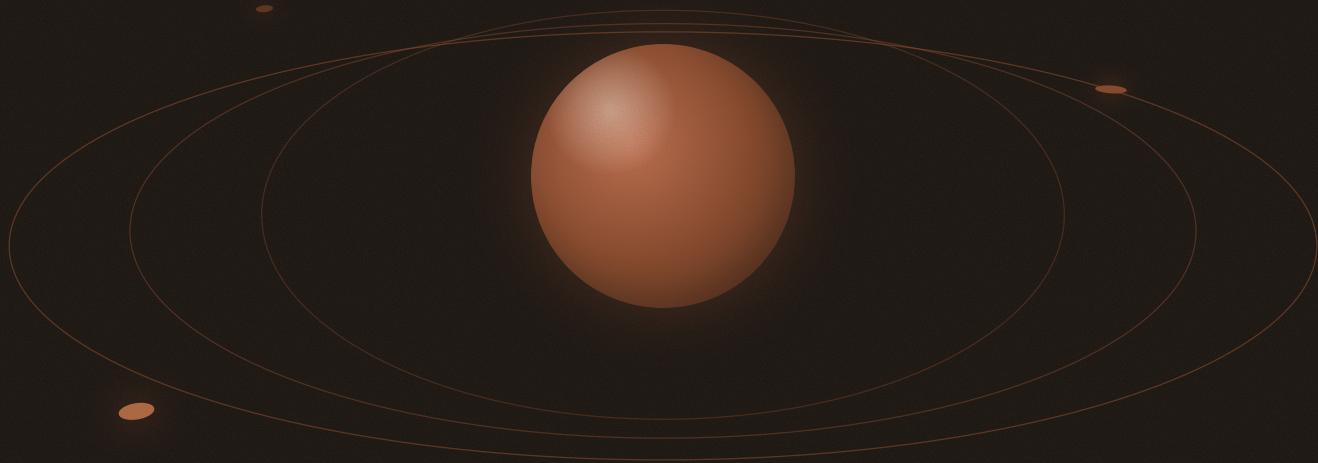
L · Deck title



M · Navigation · footer · sidebar

The orb, with rings.

Inside the product, the orb can be surrounded by three tilted rings and small orbiting moons — a secondary brand element that signals attention and motion. Use it sparingly, only where the app is actively thinking.



RING A rotateX(72°) rotateZ(18°) · stroke rgba(139, 74, 44, 0.22).

RING B inset 28px · rotateX(68°) rotateZ(-34°) · stroke 0.18.

RING C inset 58px · rotateX(60°) · stroke 0.14.

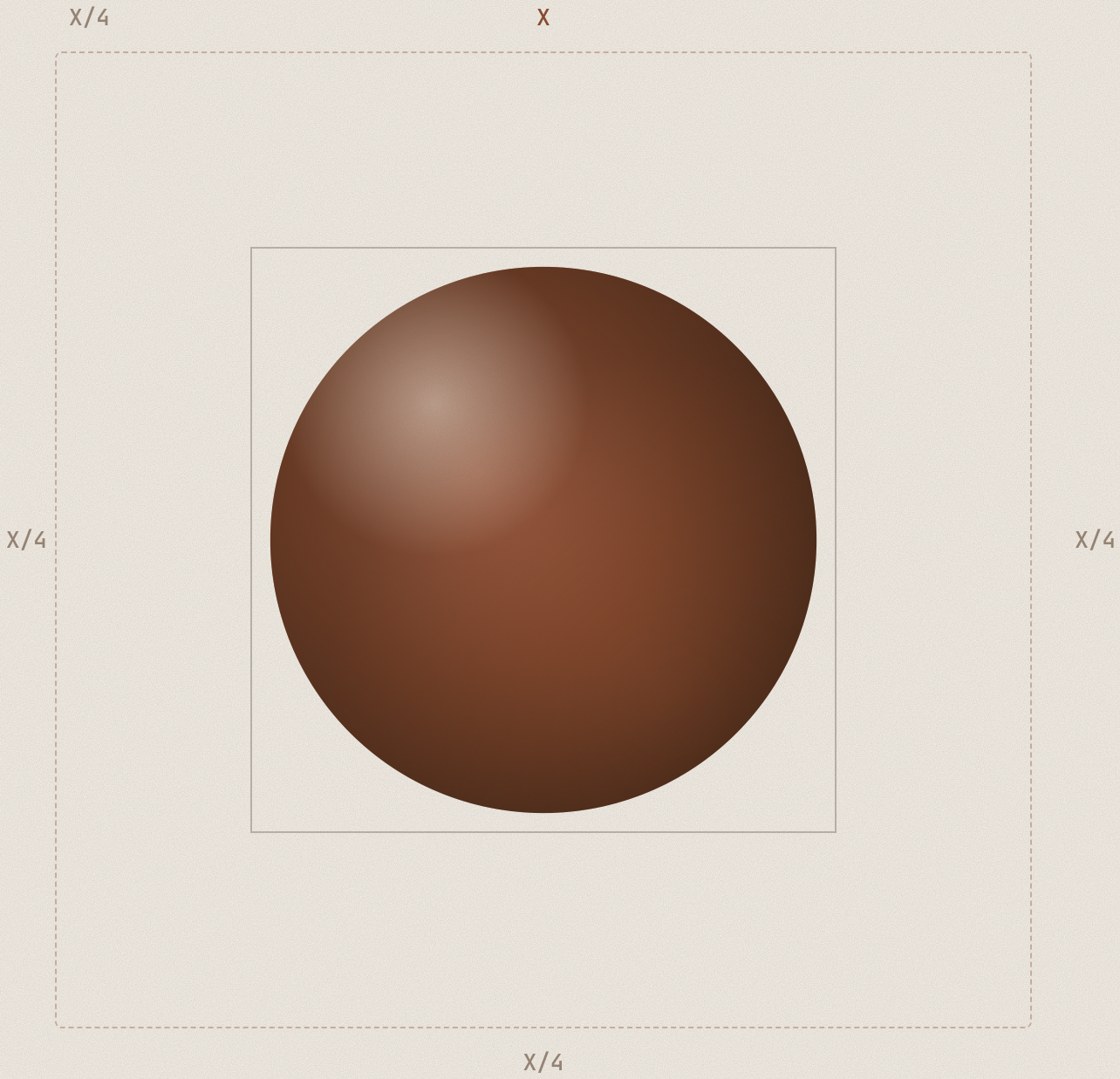
MOON A 9 px · terracotta #8B4A2C · glow 0 0 12px rgba(139, 74, 44, 0.7).

MOON B 7 px · warmer #B66B44 · softer glow.

MOON C 6 px · muted #8B4A2C at 60% · no glow.

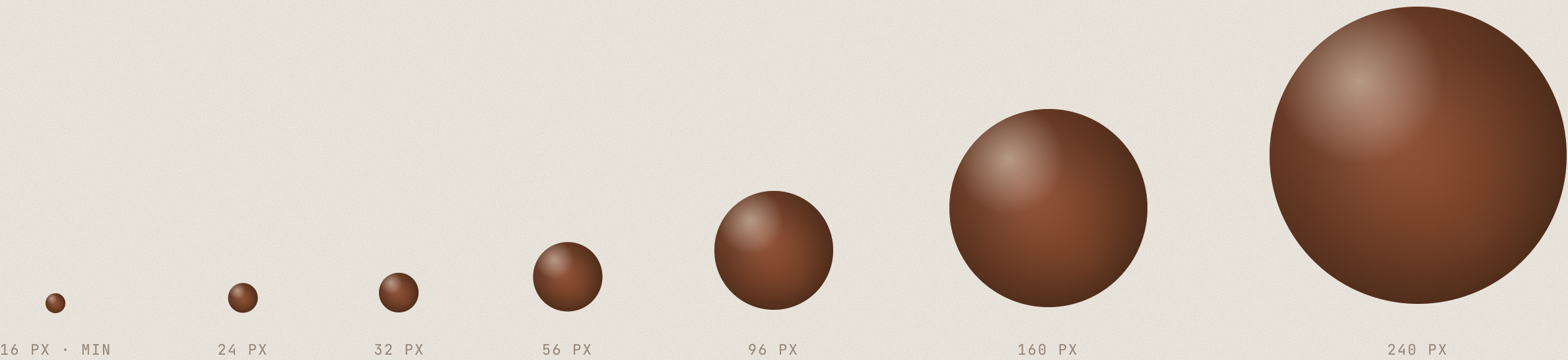
Breathing room is a quarter.

Always surround the orb with empty space equal to at least 25% of its diameter ($X/4$). Nothing — type, imagery, edges, other marks — crosses into that zone.



Below 16 px, the polish breaks.

The specular highlight and contact shadow need room to breathe. Don't reproduce the orb smaller than 16 px on screen or 6 mm in print.



Same orb. Either ground.

The polished mark is designed to read on both parchment and warm near-black. No inverse variant. The specular highlight does the work.

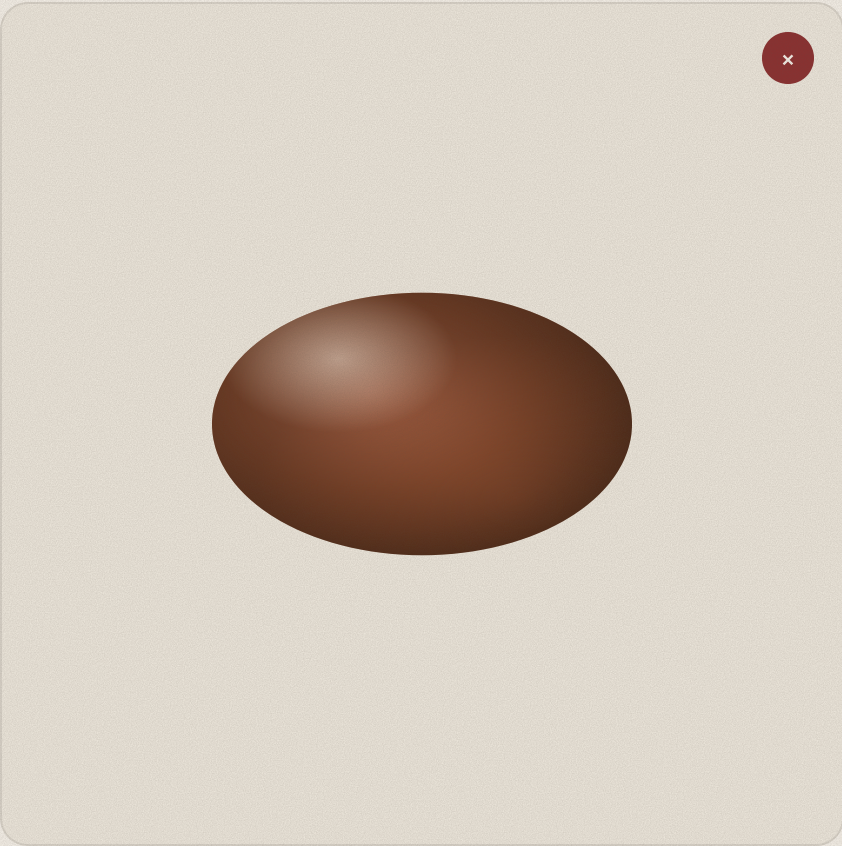


ON PARCHMENT · #F5F0E8

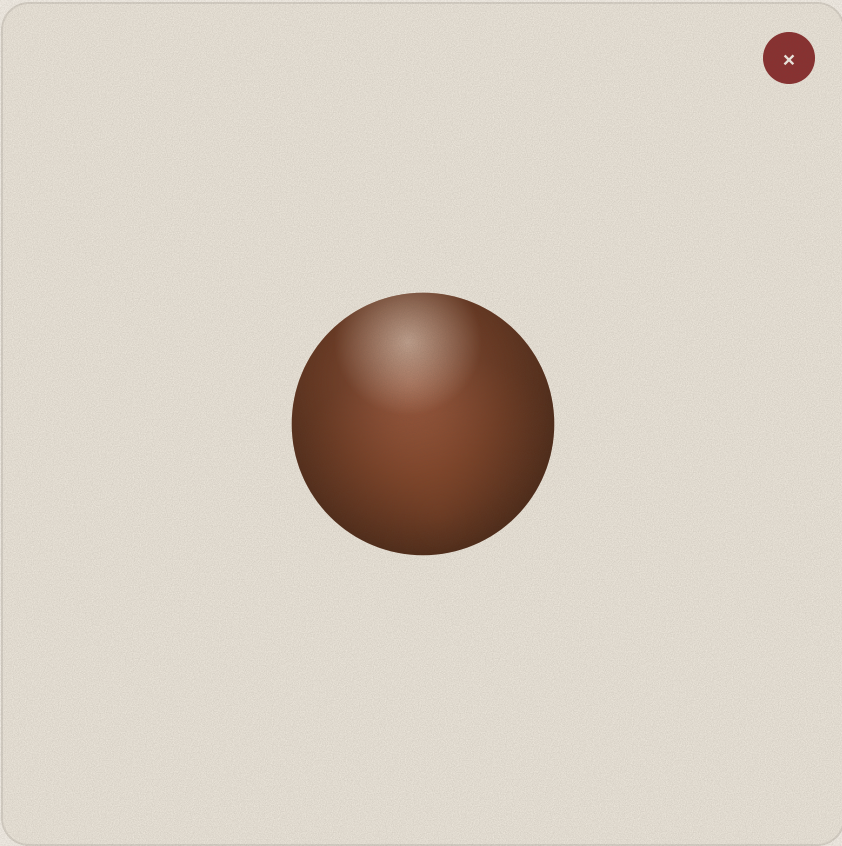


ON NEAR-BLACK · #1A1410

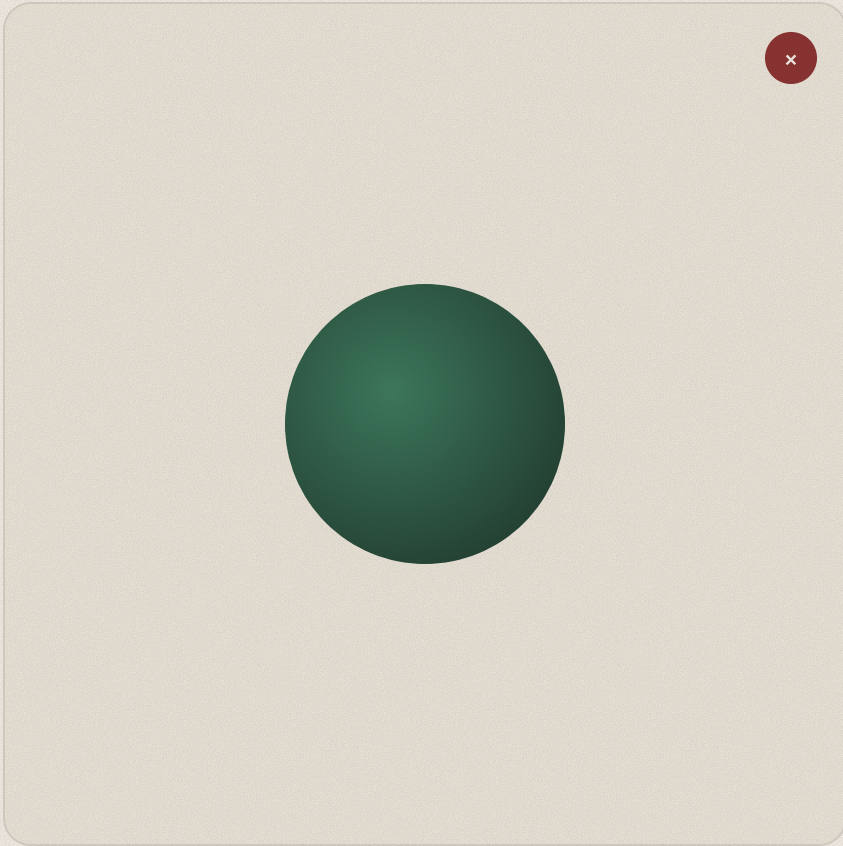
Leave the mark alone.



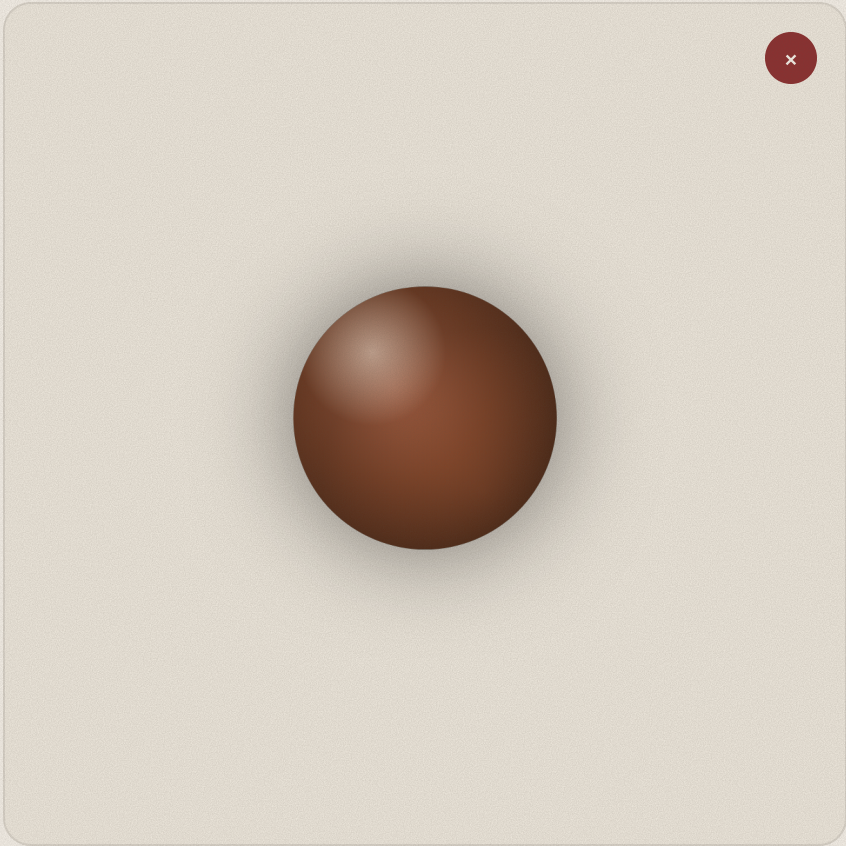
DON'T STRETCH
Never distort the aspect ratio.



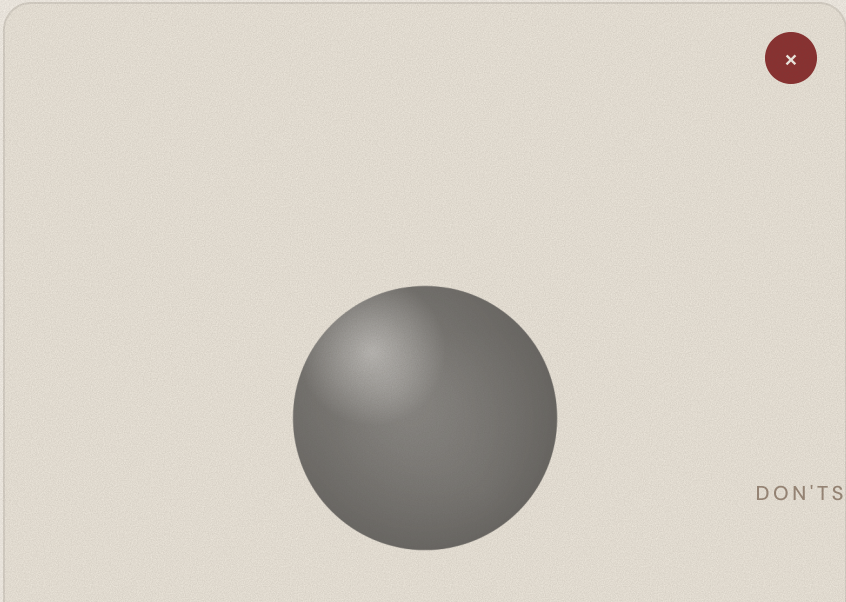
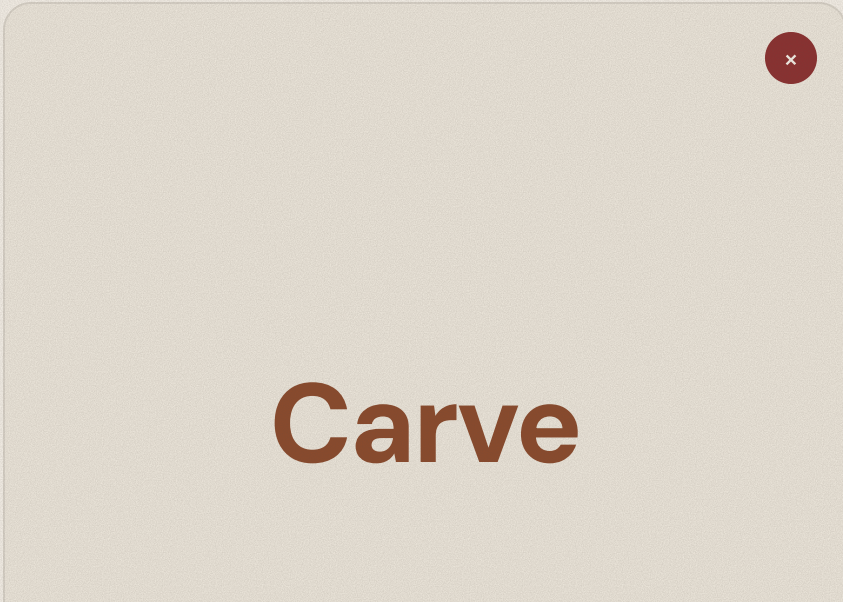
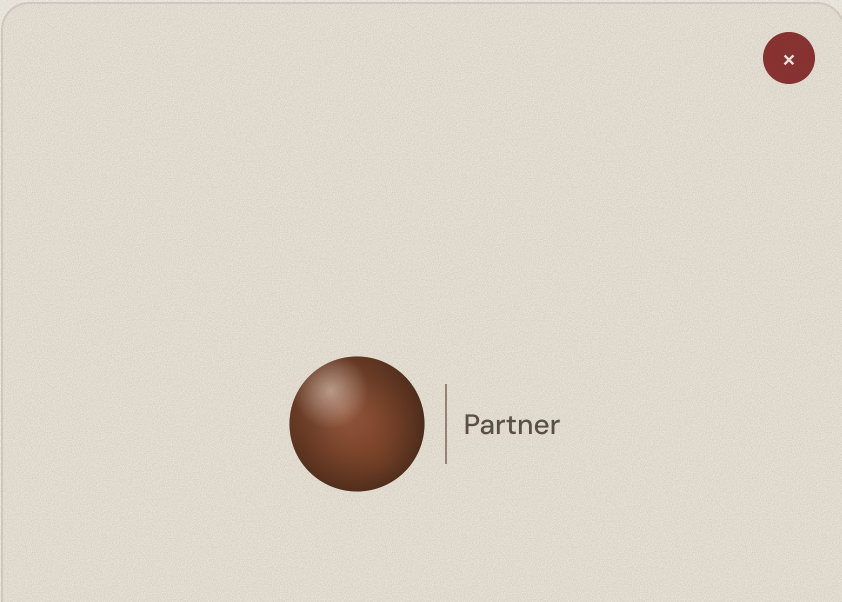
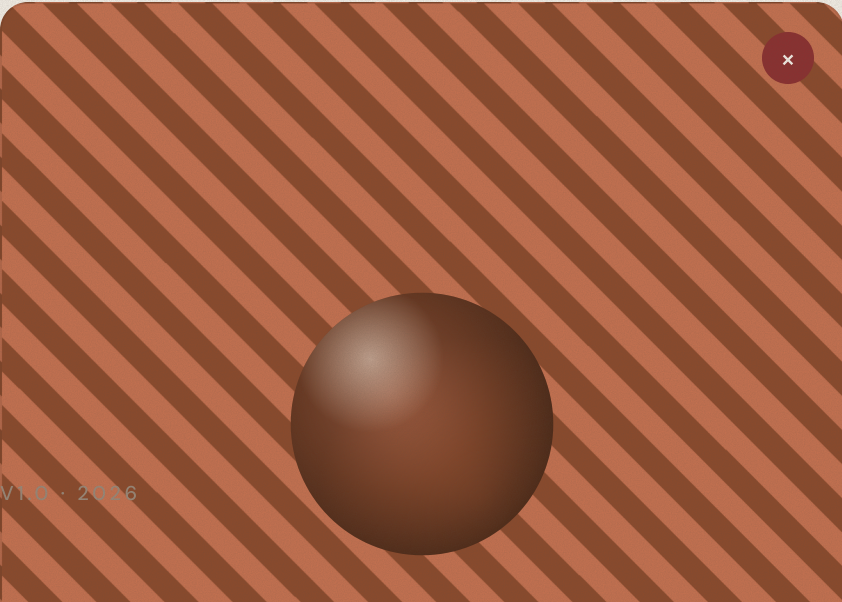
DON'T ROTATE
The light direction is fixed.



DON'T RECOLOUR
Terracotta is non-negotiable.



DON'T ADD EFFECTS
The mark ships fully lit.

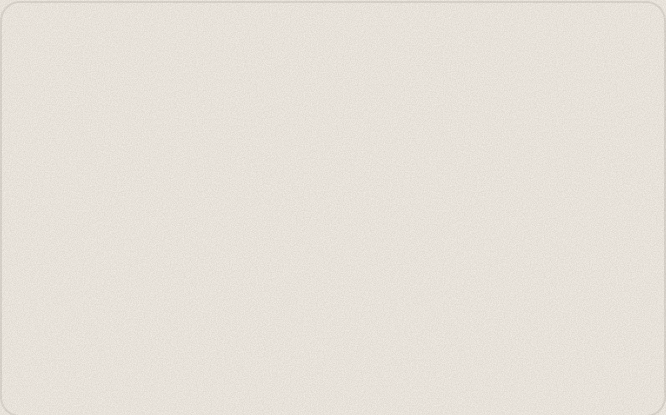


Color

*Warm sand. Burnt terracotta. Warm near-black.
Nothing grey. Nothing cold.*

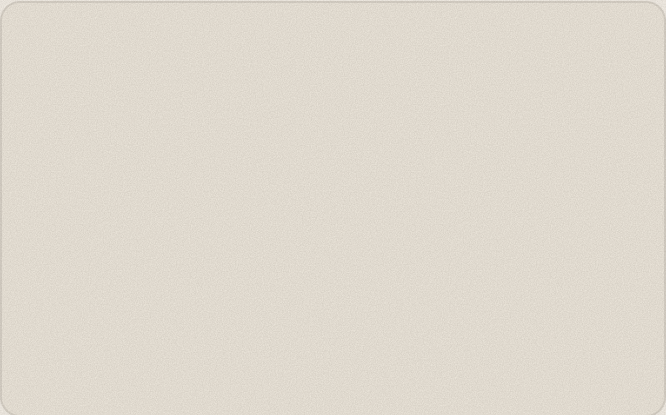
The working set.

Five parchment steps, four text weights, terracotta as the only accent. Every neutral has warm brown baked in — there is no pure grey anywhere in the system.



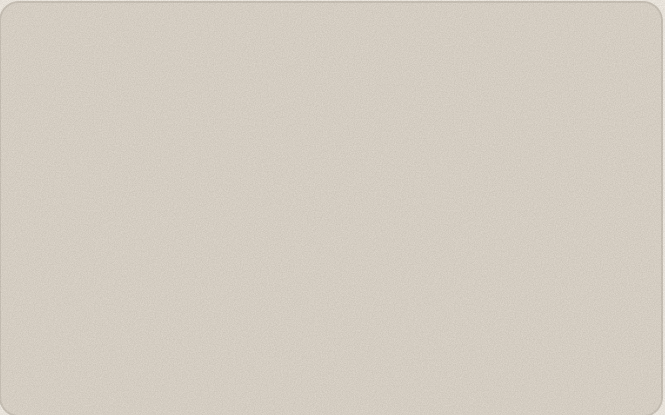
Parchment · BG

HEX F5F0E8
RGB 245 240 232
CMYK 2 3 7 0



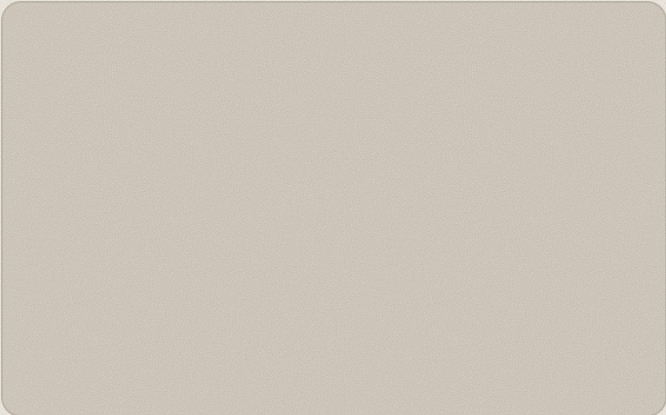
Parchment · BG 2

HEX EDE7DC
RGB 237 231 220
CMYK 3 5 11 0



Parchment · BG 3

HEX E0D9CE
RGB 224 217 206
CMYK 5 7 14 0



Parchment · BG 4

HEX D8D0C4
RGB 216 208 196
CMYK 7 9 17 0



Near-black · Text

HEX 1A1410
RGB 26 20 16
CMYK 60 65 70 90



Terracotta · Accent

HEX 8B4A2C
RGB 139 74 44
CMYK 30 75 90 25



Terracotta · Deep

HEX 7A3D22
RGB 122 61 34
CMYK 35 80 95 40



Text 2 · Body

HEX 5C4F45
RGB 92 79 69
CMYK 40 50 60 60



Text 3 · Muted

HEX 9A8878
RGB 154 136 120
CMYK 25 35 45 25



Terracotta · Soft

HEX C57150
RGB 197 113 80
CMYK 15 65 75 0

Meaning, not style.

Three additional hues for data only — positive, negative, caution. Each is a warm version of its usual counterpart. They never compete with terracotta because they only appear next to numbers.



POSITIVE

Score up, improvement, success.

HEX 2D6A4F
RGB 45 106 79
TINT rgba(45, 106, 79, 0.10)



NEGATIVE

Score down, error, broken state.

HEX 8B3030
RGB 139 48 48
TINT rgba(139, 48, 48, 0.10)



CAUTION

Mid score, attention, warning.

HEX 8B6430
RGB 139 100 48
TINT rgba(139, 100, 48, 0.10)

How to spend the accent.

Terracotta is expensive. It's the single color moment on a page — used where a reader should look, never to decorate.

USE	Primary CTAs, active navigation, the eyebrow dash, badges, score-bar highlights. Anywhere the eye needs to anchor.
USE	Hover underlines on links, inline emphasis on a single noun per paragraph. One moment of color per view.
AVOID	Terracotta backgrounds that run full-width. The color loses meaning when it's everywhere.
AVOID	Gradients on buttons, panels, cards. We use flat fills with paper grain, not gradients.
NEVER	Purple, violet, indigo, or bright blue as an accent. Not part of the system.
NEVER	Pure black (#000) or pure white (#FFF) anywhere in the UI. Every neutral must carry brown.

Typography

*A serif that moves in italic. A sans that reads
without trying. A mono for facts.*

Cormorant Garamond, set in italic.

Used only as a display face for hero headlines, quotes, section taglines. Weight 300, italic. At large sizes the italic has genuine movement — the typographic signature of the brand.

Ag

FAMILY

Cormorant Garamond

WEIGHTS

300 italic · 400 italic

TRACKING

−0.035em at hero

SOURCE

Google Fonts

DM Sans, four weights.

A neutral grotesk that carries the weight of the product UI and all running copy. Its low contrast and gentle apertures keep dense data surfaces calm.

300 · LIGHT

The polished sphere of commerce

400 · REGULAR

The polished sphere of commerce

500 · MEDIUM

The polished sphere of commerce

600 · SEMIBOLD

The polished sphere of commerce

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 & · —

JetBrains Mono, for facts.

Used for SKUs, IDs, timestamps, numbers, and anything that belongs in a column. Monospace keeps tabular data aligned without additional work.

SKU-8421	Linen throw · natural	+12
SKU-8422	Bouclé pillow · sand	-04
SKU-8423	Ceramic vase · ochre	+07
SKU-8424	Walnut tray · round	±00

0123
4567
89:.

Eleven sizes. No more.

A single scale covers every surface — marketing, product, decks. Deviation requires a reason.

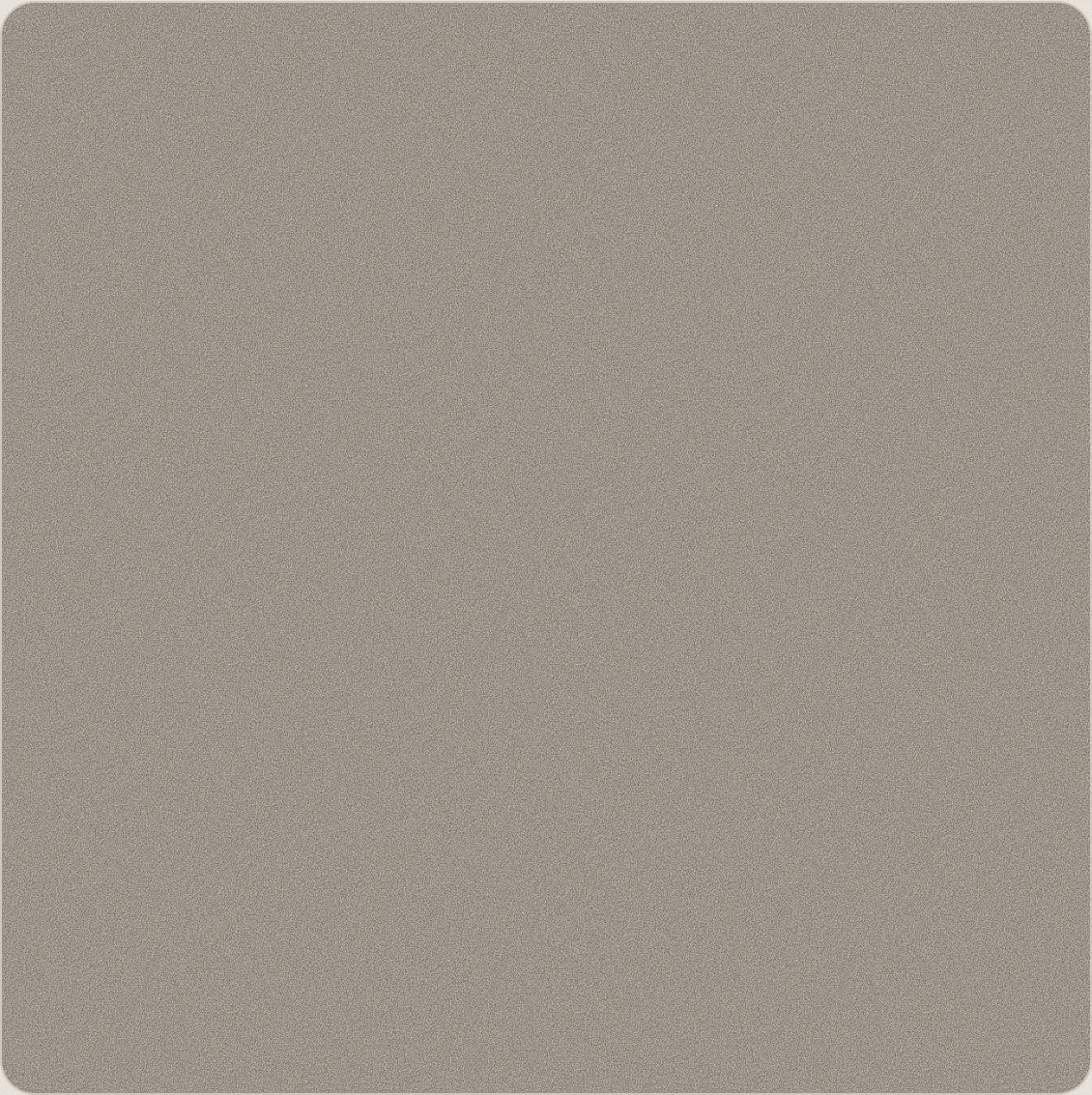
ROLE	TYPEFACE	SIZE	WEIGHT	LEADING	TRACKING	SAMPLE
Hero	Cormorant <i>italic</i>	56–84 px	300	1.02	-0.02	<i>Hero</i>
H1	DM Sans	40–48 px	400	1.10	-0.025	Section title
H2	DM Sans	32–36 px	400	1.15	-0.02	Section subhead
H3	DM Sans	22–26 px	500	1.25	-0.015	Card title
H4	DM Sans	18 px	500	1.35	-0.01	Field label
Body LG	DM Sans	17 px	300	1.70	0	Intro paragraph
Body	DM Sans	15 px	400	1.65	0	Running copy
Small	DM Sans	13 px	400	1.55	0	Caption, timestamp
Eyebrow	DM Sans	11 px	500	1.40	+0.09	EYEBROW LABEL

Surfaces

Paper grain across every background. Slow, confident motion. Nothing that bounces.

Every surface is paper.

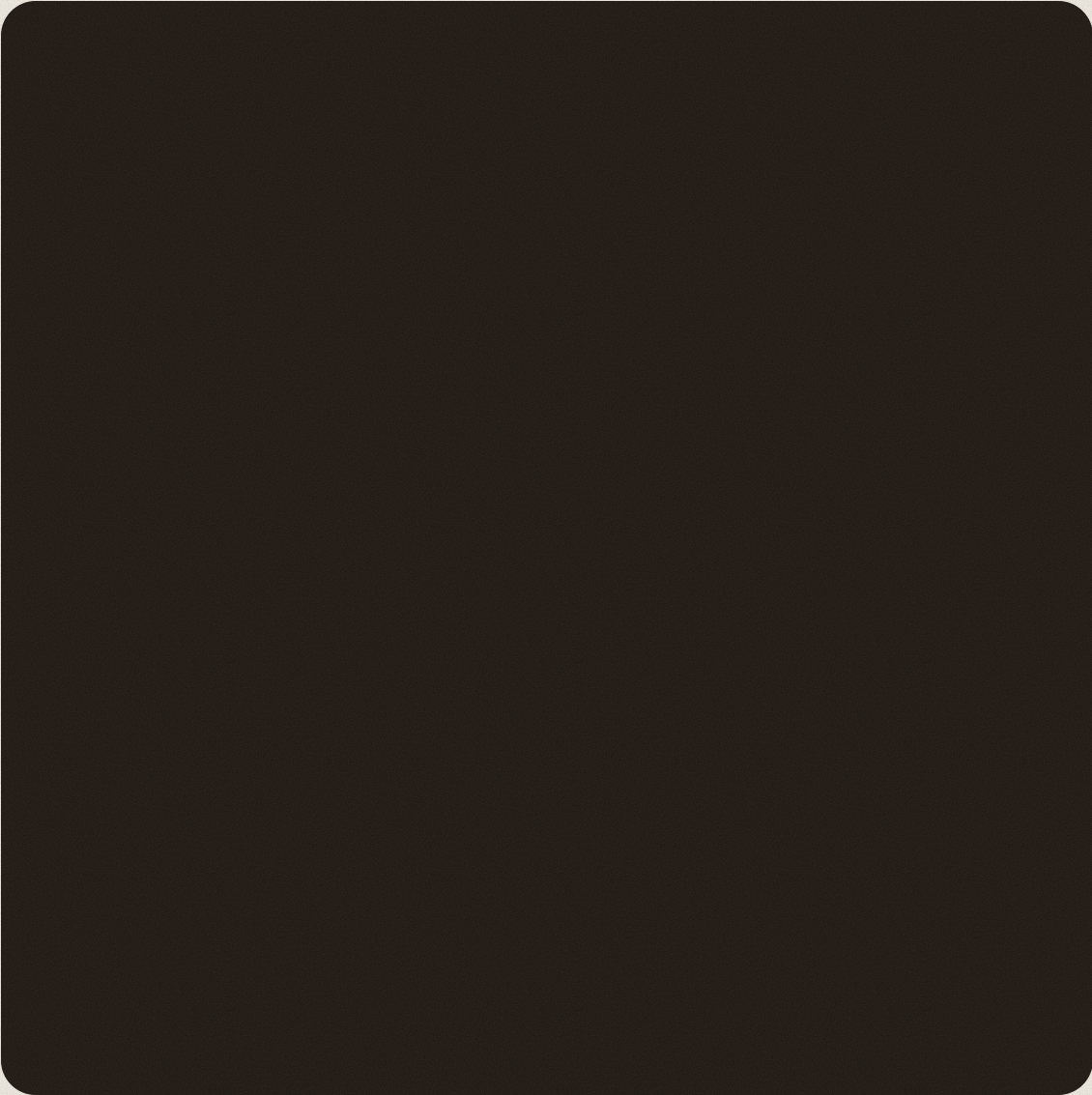
An SVG turbulence filter, scaled to 180 px, sits at very low opacity on every background. It's what makes our flat fills feel lit rather than printed from a web app.



TEXTURE SOURCE · 25% OPACITY (SHOWN FOR REFERENCE)
V1.0 · 2026



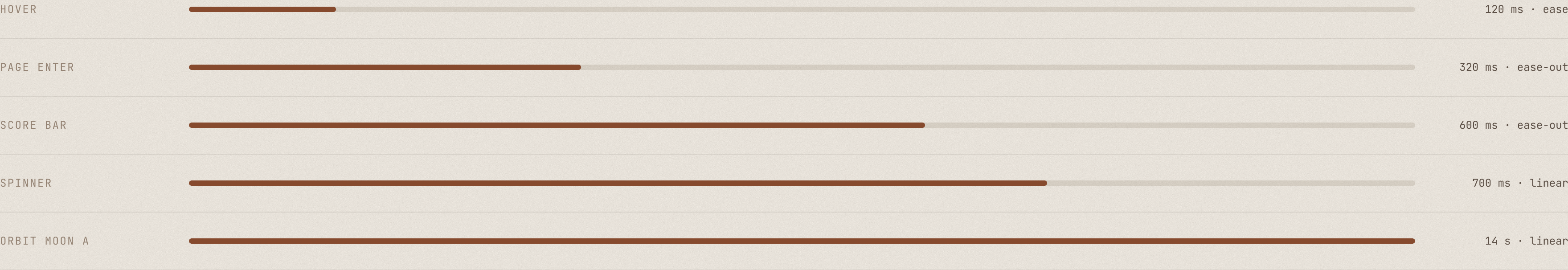
ON PARCHMENT · 3.5% OPACITY



ON NEAR-BLACK · 4% OPACITY

Slow in. Never out.

Motion in Carve is a decelerating curve. Ease-out easing `cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)`. No spring, no bounce, no overshoot — ever.



Fade-up stagger.

Entry animations are a 10 px upward fade at 320 ms. Elements stagger at 60 ms intervals — four steps max. Past that, it reads as motion graphics, not motion.

Never.

No spring, overshoot, bounce, rotate, or scale beyond 1.02. Reduced-motion media query collapses durations to 0.01 ms and runs one iteration only.

*Make every
agent choose you.*